FREELANCE SINCE 2013 · TOULOUSE, FRANCE · REMOTE

Lead Front-End Developer.

React, React Native & cross-platform.

● AVAILABLE NOW full time or 3 days/week



Max. Maxime Thirouin

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I make front-ends simple. Simple is the hard part.

Almost two decades turning tangled front-ends into systems teams can actually maintain: simpler architecture, less overhead, and devs who level up along the way. Today I own the whole front-end, from architecture to release - strict types, end-to-end (E2E) tests and CI keep it safe at that pace.

YEARS	PROJECTS	CLIENTS	DOWNLOADS / MONTH	GITHUB STARS
19	**20+**	**15+**	**200M+**	**12.3K**
pro since 2007	freelance since 2013	companies served	on OSS packages I created	across 89 repos I own

Skills

Front-End Architecture

Simpler systems, less overhead, teams that ship.

- Modernizing legacy React codebases
- Design systems & component APIs
- Performance & rendering budgets
- Accessibility, validated by disabled users
- Release automation & end-to-end (E2E) testing
- Maintainability at scale
- Mentoring & technical direction

Languages & Tooling

TypeScript · JavaScript · Node.js · HTML / CSS · REST · GraphQL · Playwright · Detox · Storybook · CI/CD · Jenkins · Fastlane

Cross-platform

React · React Native · Expo · Web · iOS · Android

AI-assisted engineering

AI coding agents (Claude Code), daily · Precise intent in, working code out · Strict types, end-to-end tests & CI as the safety net

JavaScript · TypeScript · CSS · React · Native · Expo · Next.js · PostCSS · Storybook · Playwright · Detox · Claude

Experience

Lead Front-End Developer
Exem
Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

Owned the front-end end to end on a nationwide EMF data explorer. Map sits behind the whole app and stays in sync both ways: every pan, filter and selection lives in the URL, so any view can be shared or restored, even with several maps on screen at once. Far more measurement points than a map can draw, so they cluster with Supercluster. Built the component library from scratch, every piece with a skeleton state instead of a spinner, so the UI never flashes empty.

100+ components built · End-to-end front-end ownership

Mapbox · React Strict DOM · TanStack Start · OpenAPI · Storybook · TypeScript

Lead Front-End Developer
Aardvark Intelligence
Apr 2024 – Jan 2026

A generative-AI product turning legal & financial documents into structured data - with a UI that had to stay instant on 50,000+ rows. I was the entire front-end: built the virtualized spreadsheet-like editor, then made Playwright guard its performance in CI, so a 2-week release train never shipped a regression.

50k+ rows · 2 weeks release cadence · End-to-end front-end ownership

Virtualization · Performance · Playwright · CI/CD · TypeScript · React Native Web

Lead Front-End Developer
Hove
2017 – 2018 · 2019 – 2023

Created the white-label iOS & Android transit app for cities and grew the team to 10 devs across 20 client networks. Called back by the CTO a year later to rescue it: I rebuilt it as a smaller, senior team, stabilized the product, and turned a full day of manual multi-client QA into a one-click Jenkins pipeline with Detox end-to-end tests for critical paths. Made the app fully accessible, validated by a disability users' association.

900M+ trips / year · 4M+ people served · 10 devs led · 1 day → 1 click QA & release

React Native · React Native Web · Accessibility · Detox · Jenkins · Fastlane

University Lecturer
IUT Blagnac
2012 – 2015 · 2018 – 2020

Teaching alongside my missions: C programming & web fundamentals (HTML/CSS/JS) to 1st-years, then Agile methodology to 2nd-years. The habit stuck: reviewing code to level up a team is the part of the job I like most.

200+ students taught · 6 years taught

Teaching · Agile · C · JavaScript · CSS · HTML

Open Source

1.3K followers · on GitHub since 2009

Contributing to open source since the early days. The PostCSS plugins I created - postcss-calc, postcss-custom-properties, postcss-color-hex-alpha & co - are downloaded 200M+ times a month. GitHub Arctic Code Vault Contributor.

cssnext Creator & Maintainer · 2014 – 2017

5.3k GitHub stars

130k+ downloads / week · 380+ commits · 20+ postcss plugins

Babel for CSS - write tomorrow's CSS today. My work lives on in postcss-preset-env.

stylelint Originator · 2015

10M+ Downloads / week Issue #1 started the project

Opened the first issue that started stylelint, now the standard CSS linter.

phenomic Creator & Maintainer · 2015 – 2020

3.2k GitHub stars Next.js static rendering

One of the first React static-site generators - a precursor of Next.js SSG.

rescript-react-native Maintainer · 2017 – 2022

35 Repos maintained

1.2k+ stars across the org · React Native API hand-mapped

Took over and grew the type-safe React Native bindings for ReasonML/ReScript.

Also: **PostCSS** org creator · 500+ commits · **react-native** core contributions

Additional Experience

2023 – 2026	**Portfolio & VOD Platform** · FKLG Production	Site & VOD platform for Kyan Khojandi's studio (Bref, Bloqués)
2024	**Restaurant Finder** · Enjoy App	Mobile app to find food and drinks near you.
2019	**Media/TV Remote App** · Loewe	TV/media remote app made with React Native, ReScript, GraphQL & Apollo
2016 – 2017	**Specific Admin App** · Mphasis	Web app built to manage dynamic resources with a complex database
2015 – 2016	**Workflow Management App** · One2Team	Mobile (iOS / Android) app to manage customizable lists of configurable resources
2015	**TV Web app** · Molotov.tv	Audit for Molotov.tv fresh React codebase for desktop website
2015	**Web Widget** · BeOp	Third-party widget for brands and publishers
2014 – 2015	**Accounting app** · ViaReport	Modernize a legacy bulky UI into an accessible one with modern techs
2014	**Event app** · Airbus	Companion web app for Airbus live events

Earlier: Social Share · Jirafe (now part of SAP Hybris) · Shopbot · Fittingbox · Roularta Media Group · Kiweb.

Testimonials

> As CTO at Hove, I was lucky to have Maxime in my teams **for at least 3 years**. He is truly a **top React expert** — whether it's React Native or React.js, nothing stands in his way.



Aissa Belaid
CTO at Hove

> Max is one of those really rare engineers who doesn't just work on a project but **takes ownership of it** as well. [...] As a scrappy startup where absolutely every dollar mattered [...] we found ourselves **consistently looking for reasons to hang on to Max**.



James Feore
Co-Founder, Aardvark Intelligence

> He's always **available and a real teacher**, which is how I got to grips with React Native so quickly. He loves sharing his thirst for learning, which is **a real driving force for a team**.



Alexandre Broutin
Software Engineer at Hove

All recommendations on linkedin.com/in/MaxThirouin

Talks & Community

CONFERENCE TALKS
17
in French & English

BLOG POSTS
49
on moox.io & putaindecode.io

PUTAINDECODE.IO
co-founder
FR dev community, blog & podcast

Selected: "A static website with React? Really?" - dotJS 2016 · "Back to the CSS" - dotCSS 2014 · "L'ère Post CSS" - Codeurs en Seine 2016 · "You might not need redux" - React Toulouse #2

Education

Professional Bachelor - Internet Development
IUT Rodez · 2006 – 2007

DUT - Computer Science
IUT Blagnac · 2003 – 2006

Beyond Code

CrossFit · Climbing · DJ · Standup · Pekin Express #20

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Full history & all my experiences online:
moox.io